Chicago DevSecOps Forum 2024

Post-event report | April 2 to April 4, 2024 | Chicago | in-person tech event | Venue: Lakeshore Conference Center

1. Executive summary

The Chicago DevSecOps Forum 2024 welcomed 769 attendees out of 959 confirmed registrations (1,030 registrations in total), a show-up rate of 80%. Attendees rated the program 3.90 out of 5 on average, for a net promoter score of -1. 10 sponsors took part; 9 of them met their lead target, and sponsors collected 1,567 leads against a combined target of 1,270. The event cost $335,500 against a budget of $326,000 (+2.9%).

2. Audience

The largest attendee groups were Data Scientist (134), CTO (132), IT Director (131). Most attendees came from United States (73%), Canada (9%), Germany (5%).

3. Program highlights

The program ran 30 sessions. The highest-rated sessions were AI & ML with Nikhil Fischer (rated 4.76, 80 attendees); Product with Hiro Garcia (rated 4.69, 80 attendees); AI & ML with Farah Jensen (rated 4.68, 103 attendees). The lowest-rated session was Security with Rafael Patel (rated 2.45). A highlight of the event: the sponsor networking reception was the best-rated social event.

4. Venue and operations

The main operational issue was that the registration queue peaked at 25 minutes on the first morning. In response, two extra badge printers were opened and a walk-in lane was added.

5. Sponsor results

Sponsor	Package	Leads	Target	Attainment
Brightpath Security	Title Sponsor	256	225	114%
Quillon Security	Title Sponsor	244	225	108%
Harborview Software	Premier Booth	235	145	162%
Hollis Security	Premier Booth	205	145	141%
Northgate Medical	Premier Booth	186	145	128%
Vertexa Cloud	Premier Booth	171	145	118%
Bluefin Software	Standard Booth	90	80	112%
Lumen Cloud	Standard Booth	75	80	94%
Tidewater Press	Exhibitor Table	64	40	160%

Apex Health	Exhibitor Table	41	40	102%

Sponsor feedback: Harborview Software asked for a larger booth near the coffee station.

6. Lessons learned

Lesson: too many confirmed registrants did not show up. Recommendation for the next edition: send a reminder email 48 hours before the event, with the agenda and a calendar invite.